EXAMINED

# Ottomate Smart Fan

While it looks no different from a regular ceiling fan, the Ottomate Smart fan carries a few tricks up its sleeve to claim the 'smart' monicker. Sitting next to the motor inside the central dome is a Qualcomm CSR1020 QFN chipset, which is considered the "brain" of the fan. It features a 16-bit processor, 80 kilobytes of RAM, 60 kilobytes of internal storage space for applications, Bluetooth 4.2, Bluetooth Low Energy, and CSRmesh. The fan also has integrated temperature and humidity sensor made by STMicroelectronics. All this is what lets the fan talk to the Ottomate app on an Android smartphone. The fan can also be operated using a proprietary Ottomate remote control, which is an optional purchase. The fan speed can be tweaked on a continuous scale of 1 to 100, with a turbo-mode adding a 10% boost. A breeze mode varies the fan speed every few seconds to create the effect of a breeze. This may not be everyone's favourite mode, because most of us are just not used to such a mode where the fan keeps slowing down and spinning faster, seemingly randomly. Instead of forgetting the fan is there, this kind of keeps drawing your focus back to it... There's also the Otto mode (basically a cute way of saying auto mode) that uses the sensors onboard to determine the right fan speed. In our installation, operating the fan generated a lot of noise. The Ottomate app itself is a hassle to use since it takes a few seconds to communicate with the fan every time it is launched, alongside other issues. Overall, the Ottomate Smart Fan is an advanced ceiling fan with the potential to be truly smart, but right now, is just trying too hard. Hopefully, the next version irons out these kinks and brings support for digital assistants like Alexa, Google Assistant onboard.

Price: ₹4,199/-

# Sennheiser Memory Mic

Despite its bulk, the unit is surprisingly light and can be worn comfortably or even attached to kids, pets and objects through the magnetic clip. However, it is very noticeable particularly in close up video, and not as discreet it claims to be. We have a slight problem with the white colour as well, as it is easy to attract dust and stains, which can easily show up and look ugly in HD video.

Then there are a whole bunch of issues with the Memory Mic application, which is required to use the product. Setting up is not quick and dirty, but you will end up appreciating the thoroughness of the process. The device is first calibrated, and does not allow you to start recording without this step. While there are options to record audio or video, it has to be done through the application only, and the mic itself has no buttons except an on/off switch. More applications for the device could easily open up, if only it supported recording without having to be paired with the app. Syncing can be a bit iffy, and it sets up its own WLAN hotspot every time it syncs the audio or video. Do not expect it to be fast, especially at say live events. There are three sensitivity options available, depending on the amount of ambient noise. If recording with synced video, it can only be done through the application itself. The options for video recording are rather basic, and content creators might be comfortable with other video recording applications. However, the simplicity and lack of options can also work in favour of the device, and it works as expected if you take the time to understand the idiosyncrasies.

The audio quality is just about as good as it gets, comparable to production quality condenser microphones. There is nothing to complain about here. The audio is recorded in PCM audio, stores files in the .wav format, with the settings at 16 bit and 48 KHz. The bitrate is 768 Kbps. The application provides no options to tweak the audio quality or format, so if you do not directly save the video, this is the single audio setting that you are stuck with. Note that this mic is an omni pickup, and will capture all ambient sounds.

PRICE: ₹18,427/-